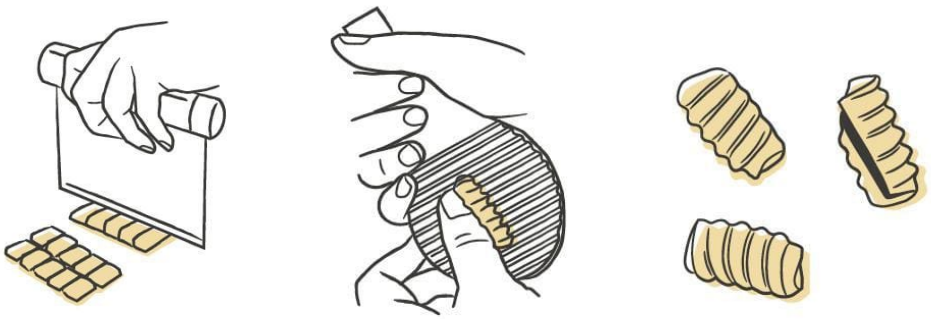
MALLOREDDUS

REGION
Sardinia, in the south near Cagliari

METHOD

1. Make an egg-based or semolina dough. Dust a wooden board with a little 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
2. Quarter the dough. Work one piece and keep the rest under plastic wrap or a towel.
3. Press the piece into a thick rope by hand. Set the fingertips of both hands together at its midpoint, then roll back and forth while walking your hands apart toward the ends.
4. Keep rolling under light pressure until the rope is about 1/2 inch across, roughly as thick as a Sharpie. Cut it in half and roll the halves separately if it gets too long to handle.
5. Cut the rope into 3/4-inch pieces with a knife or bench scraper. Cover the pieces you are not shaping.
6. Press a piece into the ridged board with your thumb and drag it down the surface, rolling your thumb out and away from you as you go. The piece curls into a small shell with ribs on the outside. Work through the rest of the cut pieces.
7. Lay the finished pasta on the sheet pan in a single layer.
8. Repeat from step 3 with the remaining dough.
9. To hold it, wrap the pan in plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



1 2 3

NOTES

Dimensions run 1/2-inch rope cut into 3/4-inch pieces. Sizes vary in Sardinia from about the length of a peanut shell down to a fingernail.
Needs a ridged surface for the thumb drag. A malloreddus or gnocchi board is the usual one; a fork's back, a cheese grater, or a bamboo mat all substitute. The ribs are what grab sauce.
One of the easier shapes, and it tolerates most doughs. The traditional dough is semolina and water, sometimes tinted and flavored with saffron; egg dough gives a lighter result.
This is a strascinati shape, meaning the dough is dragged across a surface rather than rolled or wrapped. It is closer to cavatelli and orecchiette than to potato gnocchi, despite the alias gnocchetti sardi.
No drying step. Refrigerator limit is 24 hours.
Traditional pairing is malloreddus alla campidanese. It also works in a light seafood brodo, with clams, sea beans, and saffron, or in a red sauce with saffron.

DOUGH
Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading

up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

> 454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
> Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
> Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
> Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DOUGH

Semolina Dough

Makes: 750 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

325 g	Tipo 00 flour
175 g	Semolina flour
250 g	Lukewarm water
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Stir the two flours together thoroughly, then mound on a wooden surface with a well 5 to 6 inches across.
2. Add the water slowly. Water has no body of its own, so it escapes far more easily than yolks do.
3. Draw in flour from the inner wall with a fork as you pour, working round the circumference until all the water is in.
4. Knead 8 to 10 minutes, pressing down and away, rotating, folding.
5. Add water by the tablespoon only if it stays dry.
6. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes.

NOTES

> Eggless, so it stays more elastic and less tender than egg dough. Do not expect the Play-Doh feel here.
> 50% hydration against 500 g total flour.
> 65% of the flour is 00 and 35% semolina.
> Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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